



“[FY25] was proof that the tough but bold choices we made to sharpen our portfolio, strengthen execution and anchor growth in sciences were the right ones”

GLENN SALDHANA
CMD, Glenmark Pharmaceuticals



“We undertook a significant realignment of the business model to enhance resilience and future-readiness... It was a shift away from a unified group approach”

BIKASH PRASAD
Group CFO, UPL

exports pressured global steel prices, while capacity in regional markets intensified competition.” On top of that, there was geopolitical tension, which disrupted supply chains.

By contrast, FY25 began with optimism. India’s steel sector saw higher output and consumption. “In FY25, Tata Steel achieved its highest crude steel production ever at 21.7 million tonnes (MT) and deliveries of 20.9 MT, driven by near full capacity utilisation across sites. Plus, we successfully commissioned India’s largest blast furnace unit (5 MT) at Kalinganagar,” says Narendran, adding that Neelachal Ispat Nigam, a recent acquisition, delivered a strong performance—₹1,000 crore Ebitda (earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation) and positive free cash flows.

Vipul Prasad, Founder & CEO, Magadh Capital Advisors, says Tata Steel’s turnaround was driven by scaling up, improving efficiency and portfolio rebalancing. “Higher output in India set the stage for higher margin production in Tata Steel’s consolidated basket. In Europe, they streamlined operations by shutting older UK blast furnaces and ramping up low-cost, high-efficiency production in the Netherlands,” he adds.

In agrochemicals, the challenges included channel



MANY FIRMS SLIPPED INTO THE RED IN FY24 AND ONLY THE STURDY ONES GOT THEIR ACT TOGETHER AND BOUNCED BACK IN FY25... OF COURSE, THAT IS NOT TO SUGGEST THAT THE IMMEDIATE FUTURE WILL BE ANY LESS DIFFICULT

destocking, excess inventory and adverse weather conditions. For UPL, the turnaround was the result of a combination of strategic and operational measures. That covered portfolio realignment, innovation-led growth, digital transformation and financial recovery, all of which triggered a surge in net profit and a \$1 billion reduction in debt.

“We undertook a significant realignment of the business model to enhance resilience and future-readiness,” says UPL Group CFO Bikash Prasad. The firm put in place four platforms—global crop protec-